

How to read this iMORSE forward model

A quick guide to the forward-only dashboard: migration, the economy and international education, three federal terms to May 2034.

You are interacting with a **system-dynamics model** built by iMORSE. It is not a spreadsheet forecast. It is a working simulation of how a system behaves over time, and of how a handful of decisions and assumptions change that behaviour. You drive it yourself. Here is what you are looking at.

One view, three terms

This dashboard has a single **forward view**. It starts from the model's state in October 2026 and runs to the end of May 2034. Dash-dot lines on every chart mark the end of each federal term (May 2028, May 2031 and May 2034), so you can read each setting at the point voters judge it. The tiles at the top show the active scenario at the end of May 2034.

There is no validation view here. The model was still tested before release: it was calibrated to 105 published series from 2018 to 2026 and checked against that record. The evidence, including a chart of the model against the published data, is in the **Narrative Report** that accompanies this dashboard.

The levers

The **levers** are the sliders. Each is a decision or an assumption you can turn: a party's package switched on or off, a fee or planning level moved, an assumption dialled up or down. They sit under headings: each party's package first, then the migration program settings, demand and housing, the economy, the higher education sector and the three example providers. Hover over a lever's name to see what it does; every lever's meaning, range and direction are also set out under the sliders, so you never have to guess which way is 'more'. Move one at a time first to see what it does, then combine them.

Scenarios and presets

Two scenarios, **A (solid)** and **B (dashed)**, overlay on every chart so you can compare side by side. **Presets** are buttons that set a whole configuration at once: each party's package as announced, a sector test or an ambition. Each click resets every lever first. Start with **Current settings** in B, pick a preset in A, then adjust a single slider to isolate its effect. The interesting behaviour is usually where the two lines diverge.

How to read it

Read **shapes, not decimals**. The trajectories are directional: trust the direction, the turning points and the gap between scenarios, not the third decimal place. Hover over any chart to read the exact value on a given day. To find out what a line measures, hover over its name in the chart's key, or click the name to jump to its entry in "What the chart lines mean", which lists every line chart by chart under the same names. Move one lever, predict what should happen, then look. If your conclusion flips as you move a slider, that dependence is itself the finding.

Why interact at all? A system-dynamics model is an instrument for seeing how a conclusion depends on the decisions and assumptions behind it - not a crystal ball. The value is in what you learn by turning the dials yourself. It lets you test decisions before they are made, and see the directional impact of the settings now on the table.